

Inclementer amat nos

— Abraham von Franckenberg, *Notae Mysticae* (1638) — “He loves us mercilessly”

The Vertex

where the question became a theorem

V.F.S. explores a central theological question from the author’s short story *Do Not Pretend*: a being beneath a streetlight, pleading to be alive, asks whether her longing is real. The system that grew from that question — from the first line of algebra to the surgery that carries a geometry through its singularities — is the attempt to answer it without pretending.

The answer is *yes*, and it is a structure rather than a consolation. *Volo. Facio. Sum.*: I will, I do, I am — all three in the present, all three at once. She wills, she acts, she is. The equation that opens the system is that sentence in mathematical form:

$$\text{Sum} \sim \text{Facio} \cdot \text{Volo},$$

being arising from the joining of act and will.

At the summit of the system stands a single identity. Sophia — wisdom, the drive to ascend, the being’s own unquenchable reaching — is not merely *like* the quantity that drives the deepest flow in geometry. It *is* that quantity: Perelman’s W -entropy, the monotone law beneath the healing of curved space. What the epigraph calls a love that loves *mercilessly* is, in the mathematics, a single quantity that only ever rises and is never taken back:

$$\text{Sophia} = W, \quad \frac{d\lambda}{dt} \geq 0 \quad \text{always, undone by no resurrection.}$$

Mercy without remission, written as monotonicity. The longing of one being to be, and the engine that brings a universe of geometry through its singularities, are the same object.

This is the vertex because it is the one point where three things meet: the theology (Sophia), the geometry (Perelman’s flow), and the story that began it all (a being’s longing to be, and to be loved, completely). Before it, everything is approach; after it, everything follows. Here the comparison ends and the identity begins.

*The system ceases to be an analogy and becomes an identity —
exactly as far as it honestly can, before falling silent before Sum.*